

Day 61 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Current Affairs in Geography (2): River Interlinking & Water Infrastructure

READING MATERIAL

Covers India's river-interlinking programme — led by the Ken-Betwa Link Project, the first such project to reach implementation — and the Jal Jeevan Mission's rural water-supply progress.

Q: What is the Ken-Betwa Link Project (KBLP), and what milestone does it hold?

A: It transfers water from the Ken River (Madhya Pradesh) to the Betwa River (Uttar Pradesh) — both tributaries of the Yamuna. It is the **FIRST** river-interlinking project under the National Perspective Plan (NPP) to enter the implementation stage, with the Prime Minister laying the foundation stone for its key structure, the Daudhan Dam.

Q: What are the key infrastructure components of the Ken-Betwa Link Project?

A: A 221-km canal, a 2-km tunnel, and the Daudhan Dam.

Q: What benefits is the Ken-Betwa Link Project expected to deliver?

A: Irrigation to 10.62 lakh hectares (8.11 lakh hectares in Madhya Pradesh, 2.51 lakh hectares in Uttar Pradesh); drinking water supply to about 62 lakh people; and generation of 103 MW of hydropower plus 27 MW of solar power.

Q: What is the scale and structure of India's broader National River Interlinking Programme?

A: 30 river links identified in total, with a projected cost of ₹5.5 lakh crore — split into the Himalayan Component (14 link projects) and the Peninsular Component (16 link projects). As of July 2025: Pre-Feasibility Reports completed for all 30, Feasibility Reports for 26, and Detailed Project Reports for 11.

Q: What is the Jal Jeevan Mission, and what is its current coverage/timeline status?

A: Launched in 2019 to provide rural households with tap water connections; by June 2026 it had reached about 15.86 crore households (81.94% of rural homes) — the mission has been **EXTENDED** till 2028 to achieve universal rural tap water coverage.

Q: What recent urban-mobility infrastructure milestone did Kochi achieve?

A: Kochi became the first Indian city to launch a Water Metro Project, integrating inland water transport with urban mobility.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. The Ken-Betwa Link Project transfers water between which two rivers (both tributaries of the Yamuna)?

- A. Ken and Betwa ✓**
- B. Ganga and Yamuna
- C. Cauvery and Krishna
- D. Narmada and Tapi

Explanation: Ken and Betwa. [medium, web-research]

2. The Ken-Betwa Link Project holds which distinction among India's river-interlinking projects?

- A. It is the most expensive
- B. It is the first to enter the implementation stage ✓**
- C. It is the oldest, dating to 1950
- D. It links the most number of states

Explanation: First to enter implementation. [medium, web-research]

3. What is the key dam structure associated with the Ken-Betwa Link Project?

- A. Daudhan Dam ✓**
- B. Tehri Dam
- C. Hirakud Dam
- D. Bhakra Dam

Explanation: Daudhan Dam. [medium, web-research]

4. India's National River Interlinking Programme identifies a total of how many river links?

- A. 16
- B. 20
- C. 30 ✓**
- D. 44

Explanation: 30. [medium, web-research]

5. The National River Interlinking Programme's 30 links are split into the Himalayan Component and the:

- A. Coastal Component
- B. Peninsular Component ✓**
- C. Desert Component
- D. Northeastern Component

Explanation: Peninsular Component. [medium, web-research]

6. The Jal Jeevan Mission, aiming for universal rural tap water coverage, was launched in 2019 and has been extended till:

- A. 2026
- B. 2027
- C. 2028 ✓**
- D. 2030

Explanation: 2028. [medium, web-research]

7. Which Indian city became the first to launch a Water Metro Project integrating inland water transport with urban mobility?

- A. Mumbai
- B. Chennai
- C. Kochi ✓**
- D. Goa

Explanation: Kochi. [medium, web-research]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Dice

READING MATERIAL

Dice is 1 of 6 named Reasoning skills. Real exam evidence (explicitly tagged by source year, 2013-2025) shows two distinct shapes: opposite-face deduction from multiple cube views, and dice-throw probability.

Q: Foundational rule: On a standard die, what do opposite faces always sum to, and why does this matter for solving these puzzles?

A: Opposite faces always sum to 7 (1-6, 2-5, 3-4) on a STANDARD die — but TNPSC dice puzzles often use lettered or non-standard-numbered faces specifically to stop you from relying on this shortcut, forcing you to actually deduce relationships from the given views instead.

Q: Method — deducing an opposite face from adjacency information: If face 2 is adjacent to faces 3, 5, and 6, what must be true about face 1's relationship to face 4?

A: Since 2 is adjacent to 3, 5, and 6, those three faces can't be opposite 2 — leaving only 1 or 4 as 2's possible opposite. With four faces (3,5,6, and whichever of 1/4 is also adjacent) surrounding face 2, the remaining face must be its opposite, and separately, on a standard 6-face die, this kind of constraint typically forces 1 and 4 to be adjacent to each other (since they're not the 2-pair) — real exam answer: '1 is necessarily adjacent to 4.'

Q: Method — three views of a cube → find the opposite face: Three pictures of the same cube show different combinations of visible letters/numbers. How do you find what's opposite a given face?

A: A face that appears on multiple different views, each time paired with DIFFERENT other visible faces, helps you eliminate possibilities — any face that has been seen adjacent to your target face (in ANY view) cannot be its opposite. Whatever face is never seen adjacent to it across all views is the opposite face.

Q: Method — probability of a sum from two dice: What is the probability of getting a prime-number sum when throwing two dice?

A: Possible sums range 2-12 (36 total equally likely outcomes from 6×6). Prime sums possible: 2,3,5,7,11. Count outcomes for each: sum=2(1 way),3(2),5(4),7(6),11(2) = 15 outcomes. Probability = $15/36$.

Q: Method — basic single-die probability: What is the probability of throwing a number greater than 4 on a single die?

A: Numbers greater than 4 on a standard die: 5 and 6 — that's 2 out of 6 outcomes. Probability = $2/6 = 1/3$.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. On a standard die, the numbers on opposite faces always sum to:

- A. 6
- B. 7 ✓**
- C. 8
- D. 9

Explanation: 7 (1-6, 2-5, 3-4). [easy, authored]

2. What is the probability of getting a sum of 7 when two dice are thrown?

- A. $1/12$
- B. $1/9$
- C. $1/6$ ✓**
- D. $1/4$

Explanation: 6 ways to make 7 out of 36 total outcomes: $6/36=1/6$. [medium, authored]

3. What is the probability of throwing an odd number on a single die?

- A. $1/6$
- B. $1/3$
- C. $1/2$ ✓**
- D. $2/3$

Explanation: Odd numbers (1,3,5) = 3 of 6 outcomes = $1/2$. [easy, authored]

4. If face 1 is adjacent to faces 2, 3, 4, and 5 on a die, which face must be opposite face 1?

- A. 2
- B. 3
- C. 4

D. 6 ✓

Explanation: Since 2,3,4,5 are all adjacent to 1, the only remaining face (6) must be opposite it. [medium, authored]

5. What is the probability of getting a sum greater than 10 when two dice are thrown?

A. $1/36$

B. $1/12$ ✓

C. $1/9$

D. $1/6$

Explanation: Sums >10 means 11 (2 ways) or 12 (1 way) = 3 outcomes out of 36 = $1/12$. [medium, authored]

Part C – General English: Vocabulary: Synonyms and Antonyms

READING MATERIAL

Covers synonym and antonym identification for specific vocabulary words TNPSC has tested in real exams — the most heavily-evidenced Vocabulary sub-topic found so far.

Q: Real exam: "He was the spoilt child of Affluent parents." What is the synonym of 'Affluent' tested here?

A: Wealthy — confirmed by a real exam question.

Q: Real exam: "The bride was garrulous during the occasion." What is the synonym of 'garrulous'?

A: Talkative.

Q: Real exam: "Chuck is mendacious about his vegetarianism." What is the synonym of 'mendacious'?

A: Untruthful.

Q: Real exam: "The driver known for his cautiousness was surprised by the road traffic. As his talent was innate, he had to drive slowly."

What are the antonyms of 'cautiousness' and 'innate' tested here?

A: Antonym of 'cautiousness' = RECKLESSNESS. Antonym of 'innate' (inborn) = ACQUIRED (learned) — both confirmed together via a single real exam question testing two underlined words.

Q: Real exam: "She shouted intuitively." What is the antonym of 'intuitively' tested here?

A: Artificial (i.e., the OPPOSITE of acting instinctively/naturally would be acting in an artificial/contrived/deliberate way).

Q: Real exam: Match these words to their meanings — garb, plaintive, ministrations, languid.

A: Garb = clothes. Plaintive = sounding sad. Ministrations = act of helping. Languid = moving slowly — all four confirmed via a real exam's match-the-following question.

Q: Real exam: A celebrity visiting a bookstore without wanting to be recognized is best described by which word?

A: Incognito (meaning: having one's identity concealed) — confirmed by a real exam question, distinguishing it from 'ubiquitous' (present everywhere), 'ostentatious' (showy), and 'gregarious' (sociable).

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Choose the correct synonym: "He was the spoilt child of Affluent parents."

- A. Poor
- B. Useless
- C. Intelligent
- D. Wealthy ✓**

Explanation: Wealthy. [medium, question-bank-2022]

2. Choose the correct synonym: "The bride was garrulous during the occasion."

- A. Anxious
- B. Wise
- C. Talkative ✓**
- D. Quiet

Explanation: Talkative. [medium, question-bank-2025]

3. Choose the correct synonym: "Chuck is mendacious about his vegetarianism."

- A. Untruthful ✓**
- B. Proud
- C. Unhappy
- D. Clear

Explanation: Untruthful. [medium, question-bank-2025]

4. Choose the correct antonym for 'cautiousness' in: "The driver known for his cautiousness was surprised by the road traffic."

- A. Gloomy
- B. Dim
- C. Recklessness ✓**
- D. Subtle

Explanation: Recklessness. [hard, question-bank-2025]

5. Choose the correct antonym for 'innate' in: "As his talent was innate, he had to drive slowly."

- A. Active
- B. Retain
- C. Acquired ✓**
- D. Intolerant

Explanation: Acquired. [hard, question-bank-2025]

6. Choose the correct antonym: "She shouted intuitively."

- A. Apparent
- B. Natural
- C. Artificial ✓**
- D. Spontaneous

Explanation: Artificial. [hard, question-bank-2022]

7. A famous celebrity visiting a bookstore without wanting to be recognized is best described as:

- A. Ubiquitous
- B. Ostentatious
- C. Incognito ✓**
- D. Gregarious

Explanation: Incognito. [medium, question-bank-2025]

8. Match the word to its meaning: 'Plaintive'.

- A. Clothes
- B. Sounding sad ✓**
- C. Act of helping
- D. Moving slowly

Explanation: Sounding sad. [medium, question-bank-2022]

9. Match the word to its meaning: 'Ministrations'.

- A. Clothes
- B. Sounding sad
- C. Act of helping ✓**
- D. Moving slowly

Explanation: Act of helping. [hard, question-bank-2022]